ANUPRIYA ACHARYA

CEO (South Asia), Publicis Groupe

With over three decades of experience in the media industry, Anupriya Acharya worked with WPP and Aegis Media before taking up her current role at Publicis Groupe in December 2019. Today, she oversees operations across Starcom, Zenith, Leo Burnett, BBH and Saatchi & Saatchi, among other businesses. Technology will continue to play a critical role in shaping the group's operations, and how it changes the media business under her leadership remains to be seen.



PHOTO BY **MANDAR DEODHAR**

ANURADHA THAKUR

SECRETARY, DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AFFAIRS

Anuradha Thakur, became the first woman to head the Department of Economic Affairs as Secretary, when she assumed charge in July 2025. Completing just over a year in this position, she has played a key role in formulating policies to offset the impact of the 50% US tariffs and the West Asia war, and initiatives to attract foreign investors in the government bond market. In the past, she has worked on the disinvestment of Air India as well as the launch of the Bharat Bond ETF. Keeping her busy now is the preparation of the Union Budget 2027-28.



PHOTO BY **SURABHI**



ANURADHA ACHARYA

CO-FOUNDER & CEO, MAPMYGENOME

Anuradha Acharya established Mapmygenome—a genomics company—in 2013 with an ambition of reaching 100 million lives. She previously co-founded and led Ocimum Biosolutions, a genomics and bioinformatics company, from 2000 to 2013. At Mapmygenome, she leads the company's business across clinical and preventive genomics, including genetic testing and health assessments. A World Economic Forum Young Global Leader, she is CEO of Microbiome Insights and champions proactive, inclusive, innovative healthcare.